

Governance and Legal Services

Nottingham Trent University
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Mr Harry Wright
harry.j.wright@protonmail.com
<< By Email Only >>

13 March 2026

Reference: 2814367

Dear Mr Wright

Your Reference: 2814367
Request for Personal Data – Subject Access Request

I write further to your Subject Access Request (SAR) made on 14 February 2026 and following correspondence, notably your email received by the University on 23 February 2026. I have already responded to several points of your request within my acknowledgement letter, sent on 23 February 2026. I do not reiterate those points here but respond to the outstanding items of concern.

Metadata

As previously explained, under the UK GDPR the University is required to provide you with copies of *your personal data*. The legislation does not require controllers to retain, recreate or disclose system-generated metadata that is not held in the ordinary course of business.

Where metadata is removed during routine document conversion processes, this does not constitute the destruction of personal data, nor does it affect the accuracy of the information processed about you. The underlying personal data remains intact and was made available for disclosure where held.

Forensic identifiers

Your email refers to workstation identifiers, originating IP addresses, and other forms of system-level forensic information. These technical logs are not data we routinely collect or store as part of the creation or management of the documents you have referenced. As such, they do not form part of the personal data to which Article 15 applies, and they are not disclosable under a SAR.

Audit Logs

Microsoft 365 Unified Audit Logs and other server-side technical logs are designed for platform administration and security. These logs are retained for a limited time period and generally do not contain information that constitutes your personal data. Nevertheless, I have corresponded with our Chief Information Security Officer's Office and they have confirmed the following:

- You are the only individual with access to your mailbox. No other individuals have access or 'send as' permissions.
- You are the only individual with access to your OneDrive (unless you have shared links to specific documentation with others from this area).

- No administrative access has occurred.

Regarding audit logs from the University's student records system (Banner), we confirm the following:

- Banner audit logs are system-generated technical outputs.
- The data is coded, highly technical, and not easily comprehensible to a lay person without specialist database knowledge.
- The logs often contain internal system references rather than plain-language explanations.
- The logs do not contain data on who has accessed your record, rather than changes made to thousands of individual data fields.

I have therefore concluded that the logs are so inherently technical, that they can not be provided in a manner that the content of that log will be meaningful to you. The data audit tables contain over 2,900,000 characters. I consider retrieving and de-coding the 2,900,000 characters (much of which will be system changes), would extend beyond the scope of a reasonable and proportionate search for data. This is because the University would be required to cross reference that data against hundreds of coded look up tables.

I provide a copy of your physical access swipe logs as requested attached.

Third Party disclosures

No ad-hoc third party disclosures have been recorded within your record. As such, no third-party disclosures log exists. The University works with a number of partners who process personal data on behalf of the University (i.e. by provision of bespoke systems). Where third parties process personal data under the University's instructions, suitable contracts, data sharing agreements or data processing agreements are in place. Further information about who we share data with and the relevant safeguards put in place can be found in our privacy notice here: <https://www.ntu.ac.uk/policies/student-privacy-notice>. A copy of a Data Sharing Agreement does not constitute your personal data and therefore is not disclosable under Article 15 of the UK GDPR.

You have referenced the Investigatory Powers Tribunal (IPT) in your correspondence. The IPT investigates the use of investigatory powers by public authorities. The University does not undertake activities that fall within the IPT's remit. Your SAR continues to be processed strictly within the framework of the UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018. I also remind you that the University is responding to your request for personal data only and is not engaged in any forensic investigation in relation to data.

I hope the above and my clarifications provided in my letter dated 23 February 2026 satisfies your concerns.

Please quote the reference number 2814367 in any future communications.

Please come back to me in the first instance, if you would like a clarification or have any queries in connection with the way your request has been handled.

If you remain dissatisfied with the way in which we have handled your request, you have a right to report your concern to the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO). You can find further information on how to do this on the ICO's website at <https://ico.org.uk/>.



Nottingham Trent
University

Kind regards,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'L Peggs'.

Lindsey Peggs

Information Governance Manager & Data Protection Officer
Governance and Legal Services